

3.2.1 Language diversity

Students should study a range of examples of language in use and research data to inform their study of diversity:

- texts using different sociolects (to include social and occupational groups, and gender)
- texts using different dialects (to include regional and national varieties of English within the British Isles)
- texts that use language to represent the different groups above
- written, spoken and electronic texts about a range of subjects, for various audiences and purposes in a variety of genres
- items from collections of language data (eg dictionaries, online resources, language corpora)
- research findings (eg tables, graphs, statistics).

When analysing texts and data, students should explore:

- how language varies because of personal, social and geographical contexts
- why language varies, developing critical knowledge and understanding of different views and explanations
- how identity is constructed
- how language is used to enact relationships
- attitudes to language diversity.